

Popularity

Python has been bestowed the TIOBE Programming Language of the Year award in 2007 and 2010. The TIOBE index measures the growth and popularity of the language over the period of one year.

Popular frameworks

Django, TurboGears, Web2py, Bottle, CherryPy, Flask, Pyramid, etc, are some of the popular frameworks.

Syntax

Python syntax is very neat and clean. The extension of the file is .py.

```
#!/usr/bin/python
```

```
print "Hello! Welcome to the world of Python!"
```

So which is the best programming language to learn and use?

There is no specific answer to this question because we can perform almost all tasks with any of the three languages. It depends on what you want to do and how you can do it efficiently. The answer to this question varies based on the applications or usage.

If Web development is the first priority, then PHP is the first preference. For test automation and scripting, Python and Perl are very popular. There are lots of frameworks available in all three languages, and since community support is good, you will never be stuck with a particular problem.

PHP has lots of popular CMS frameworks available like WordPress, Joomla and Drupal. Any newbie can deploy websites easily using these frameworks. There are lots of plugins available for these frameworks and almost all the major functionalities are covered. Similarly, Python has the Django framework, which is very popular and most Python lovers use it for Web development.

My advice would be to learn all three languages and use them based on the situation. Beginners can start with Python as it is very easy, and later jump into learning PHP and Perl, in that order. The basic logic for all the programming languages is the same and the only difference is in terms of the syntax. Usually, the person who knows one language can easily migrate to another language very quickly.

These are never ending discussions on all the forums about which is the best programming language for career growth. My advice would be to learn one language very well. Pick the one you feel comfortable with and slowly venture into exploring the other two.

My preference

I will go with Python as it is evolving very fast and is easy to learn. The use cases of Python cover a very broad range. It is used in almost every IT segment and, by learning this language,

you can do wonders in all those segments. So I prefer Python.

The most important thing is to learn the Pythonic way of writing a code. Here are a few examples.

Example 1: The 'non-Pythonic' way of writing a code:

```
def test(a, b):
    a[0] = 2
    b[0] = 7.5
abc = [0]
xyz = [0]
test(abc, xyz)
abc = abc[0]
xyz = xyz[0]
```

The Pythonic way of writing the same code:

```
def test():
    return 2, 7.5
alpha, beta = foo()
```

Example 2: The non-Pythonic way of writing code:

```
i = 0
while i < mylistlen:
    do(mylist[i])
    i += 1
```

The Pythonic way of writing the same code:

```
for i in range(mylistlen):
    do(mylist[i])
```

Another Pythonic way of writing the same code:

```
for item in mylist:
    do(item)
```

Example 3: A short program for reversing a string is shown below:

```
'Hello Python'[::-1]
```



References

- [1] <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Perl>
- [2] <https://wiki.python.org/moin/WebFrameworks>
- [3] <https://www.python.org/>
- [4] <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/PHP>
- [5] <http://php.net/manual/en/intro-what-is.php>

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